NATIONAL OCEANIC AND ATMOSPHERIC ADMINISTRATION (NOAA)
Southeast Region Office (SERO)
STATEMENT OF OBJECTIVES (SOO)

FOR
Permitting Information Management System (PIMS)
Appian Operations, Maintenance, and Enhancements

1. Purpose

The National Marine Fisheries Service (NMFS) Southeast Region Office (SERO) requires a qualified contractor to lead an effort in supporting existing Appian applications and providing continuous enhancement of NMFS mission business processes.

2. Scope

The Contractor shall provide all personnel, management, and Appian subject matter expertise (SME) to perform the following:

- End-to-End User and Application Support: Comprehensive helpdesk support, technical triage, troubleshooting, and resolution of incidents within the production environment to maintain system availability.
- Appian Lifecycle Management: Management of Appian objects (Process Models, Records, SAIL Interfaces) and integration via the Appian Data Fabric.
- Flexible Enhancement Capacity (Services-Based): Delivery of agile development services, focusing on outcomes and functional delivery rather than specific personnel, to flexibly address skill gaps, new SERO/PIMS system requirements, and continuous feature development.
- Adaptive & Perfective Enhancements: Design, development, and deployment of new features and functional improvements to existing workflows to address changing regulatory requirements and evolving mission needs.
- Platform Sustainment: Implementation of Appian hotfixes, platform upgrades, and preventive maintenance to ensure 508 compliance and cybersecurity posture.
- Agile Project Management: Participation in sprint planning, backlog grooming, and stakeholder demonstrations.

3. Period and Place of Performance

3.1 Period of Performance

- Base Year: 9/11/2026 – 9/10/2027
- Option Year One: 9/11/2027 – 9/10/2028
- Option Year Two: 9/11/2028 – 9/10/2029

- Option Year Three: 9/11/2029 – 9/10/2030
- Option Year Four: 9/11/2030 – 9/10/2031

3.2 Place of Performance
Work shall be performed at remote locations or Contractor-provided facilities. The Contractor shall ensure all personnel have the necessary infrastructure and high-speed connectivity to perform duties effectively and securely in a remote environment.

3.3 Travel
At the sole discretion of the Government, the Contractor may be required to travel to NMFS facilities (e.g., SERO headquarters in St. Petersburg, FL or Miami, FL) to support critical project meetings or system development activities. All travel must be pre-approved in writing by the Contracting Officer Representative (COR) and will be reimbursed in accordance with Federal Travel Regulations (FTR).

3.4 Hours of Operation
The Government's core business hours are 9:00 AM to 5:00 PM Eastern Time (ET), Monday through Friday, excluding Federal holidays. The Contractor shall propose a support model that ensures system availability, responsive user support, and the execution of SOO requirements during these core hours. Furthermore, the Contractor shall propose an approach for addressing and resolving critical system emergencies outside of standard support times to restore essential functionality.

3.5 Workforce Stability and Continuity
The Contractor shall maintain a stable and adequate workforce to ensure the consistent execution of the performance objectives outlined in this SOO. The Contractor shall implement effective retention and knowledge management strategies to minimize the impact of personnel turnover on Government operations. In the event of personnel changes, the Contractor is responsible for ensuring a seamless transition of duties with no degradation to service delivery, security posture, or project timelines.

4. Background
The National Oceanic and Atmospheric Administration (NOAA) National Marine Fisheries Service (NMFS) is responsible for the management, conservation, and protection of living marine resources within the U.S. Exclusive Economic Zone. Using tools provided by the Magnuson-Stevens Act, the Marine Mammal Protection Act, and the Endangered Species Act, NMFS relies on science-based assessments to predict fish stock status, ensure compliance with federal regulations, and lead the recovery of protected species while balancing economic and recreational opportunities.

The Southeast Region Office (SERO) leverages the Permitting Information Management System (PIMS) and the Enhanced Case Management System to execute its mission. These are enterprise-grade solutions built on the Appian low-code automation platform, utilized to manage vessel permit lifecycles and support the Office of Law Enforcement and General Counsel Enforcement Section.

Given the platform's mature low-code architecture, end-customers expect the rapid delivery of high-value features and the flexibility to seamlessly respond to changing priorities and changing regulatory requirements. The Agency aims to fully leverage this Appian investment to maximize efficiency and customer satisfaction. Because these core systems are already established in production, reliable Operations and Maintenance (O&M) paired with continuous application evolution and functional enhancement will be critical in achieving this significant initiative. Through this procurement, NMFS seeks a qualified industry partner to provide the technical expertise necessary to sustain and evolve these vital mission applications.

5. Performance Objectives

NMFS SERO is responsible for sustaining and evolving mission applications in support of regulatory/compliance, commerce, and conservation. To maximize the value of its Appian low-code investment, the Agency requires the Contractor to achieve the following performance objectives:

5.1 Operations and Maintenance (O&M)

- Provide comprehensive, end-to-end user and application-level support for PIMS and associated systems in the production environment.
- Deliver timely and reliable triage, troubleshooting, and resolution of system incidents, data anomalies, and software bugs to support continuous SERO business operations and a positive user experience.
- Implement an IT Service Management (ITSM) framework utilizing the Government-provided NMFS JIRA system to track, manage, and resolve all user support requests and system incidents. This framework must seamlessly integrate with Agile workflows, ensuring that support activities and bug fixes do not disrupt the momentum of new feature development.

5.2 Agile Development and Enhancements

- Design, build, and deploy new capabilities and Appian functionalities in an iterative manner to address changing regulatory requirements and stakeholder priorities. The Government anticipates a flexible pricing structure (e.g., Time and Materials or Agile Sprint capacity) for these enhancements to seamlessly accommodate evolving system requirements and skill gaps.

- Automate complex business processes and deliver device-agnostic, user-friendly features that improve the new permit request and renewal workflows.

5.3 Transition Services

- Conduct an efficient knowledge transfer from the incumbent contractor without degrading ongoing support levels.
- Ensure the incoming support team is fully operational, knowledgeable of the PIMS and Enforcement architectures, and capable of assuming full O&M and enhancement responsibilities upon the conclusion of the transition period.
- Integrate with the Government's Agile governance model. The Government will act as the Product Owner with final authority over backlog prioritization, while the Contractor shall collaboratively advise on technical dependencies and effort. The Contractor shall manage and track all user stories, tasks, and sprints using the existing Government-provided NMFS JIRA system.

6. Operating Constraints

The Contractor's proposed approach and execution of the Performance Objectives shall comply with all applicable Federal, Department of Commerce (DOC), and NOAA policies, procedures, and standards. Key operating constraints include, but are not limited to:

6.1 IT Security and Privacy Compliance

- Clearance Requirements: This is a Low Risk IT Service requirement. All Contractor personnel must undergo security processing by the Department's Office of Security (National Agency Check and Inquiries - NACI) to obtain a Public Trust determination prior to accessing DOC/NOAA IT systems. Non-U.S. citizens must meet additional residency and ICE check requirements.
- IT Security Policy: The Contractor must meet the DOC IT Security Program Policy and Minimum Implementation Standards, including the adoption of multi-factor authentication (MFA) for all applications.
- Confidentiality & PII: The Contractor shall comply with all Federal laws regarding the strict safeguarding of Personally Identifiable Information (PII). Contractor personnel will be required to sign and adhere to a Non-Disclosure Agreement (NDA).

6.2 Intellectual Property and Data Rights

- All deliverables, documents, code, and analyses are the property of the U.S. Government. Documents and data shall be stored exclusively on Government-owned equipment and shall not be saved, archived, or disseminated outside of NMFS without explicit release from the Government.

6.3 Platform Architecture and Technical Quality

- Development, deployments, and lifecycle management shall adhere to the official Appian Playbook. The Contractor shall prioritize native, out-of-the-box Appian functionality over custom plug-ins to ensure the platform remains easily upgradeable.

6.4 Section 508 Compliance

- All newly developed user interfaces, workflows, and public-facing features must strictly comply with Section 508 accessibility requirements, specifically WCAG 2.0 AA. Compliance testing must be conducted.

6.5 Government Furnished Equipment (GFE) and Access

- The Government will provide one (1) NOAA Security Badge and one (1) Desktop or Laptop with access to the NMFS network via VPN and SERO-provided accounts for each authorized Contractor employee. The Contractor shall ensure all GFE is properly safeguarded and returned upon contract completion.

6.6 Contractor Furnished Software and Licensing

- The Contractor shall be responsible for providing, renewing, and managing the software licenses for the Appian platform necessary to support this requirement.

6.7 Key Personnel

- The Contractor shall identify and lock in a Lead Appian Developer / Technical Lead. This individual is considered Key Personnel and cannot be removed or replaced from the contract without the prior written approval of the Contracting Officer.

6.8 Technical Direction

- Due to the unknown nature and timing of some of the work involved, this task order includes a time and materials (T&M) Contract Line Item (CLIN) for each performance period that will include project-specific technical direction, which may be provided via Technical Direction Letters (TDLs) or other written authorization from the COR. The Technical Direction will provide technical clarification, establish timeline(s), clarify NOAA acceptance criteria/expectations, and/or establish a budgetary limitation for a specific task. In such cases, the contractor shall not exceed the limitations specified in the Technical Direction without the advanced written authorization of the COR or Contracting Officer.

7. Service Level Expectations

While the Contractor is encouraged to propose innovative approaches to system support, the Government expects the Contractor's Quality Control Plan (QCP) and Performance Work Statement (PWS) to target the following incident response and resolution timelines during normal business hours:

- Priority 1 (Critical): Extensive/Widespread interruption making critical functionality inaccessible. Target Response: 2 hours. Target Resolution: 8 hours (with daily/ad-hoc updates).

- Priority 2 (High): Significant/Large interruption having a severe impact on service availability. Target Response: 4 - 6 hours. Target Resolution: 1 - 2 Business Days.
- Priority 3 (Medium): Moderate/Limited impact on non-critical functions; hard to use but no direct impact on overall service availability. Target Response: 1 Business Day. Target Resolution: 3 - 5 Business Days.
- Priority 4 (Low): Minor inconvenience limited to a subset of users with a viable workaround possible. Target Response: 2 Business Days. Target Resolution: 5 - 10 Business Days.

8. Deliverables Schedule

The Contractor shall provide the following standard programmatic deliverables. The Contractor may propose additional technical deliverables as part of their Agile methodology.

Deliverable	Description	Due Date
Post-Award Kickoff Meeting	Initial meeting to baseline transition strategy, establish communications, and verify security protocols.	Within 10 business days of contract award.
IT Security Orientation Training Certification	One (1) certificate per employee	Within 5 calendar days after issuance of the award by the Contracting Officer (CO)
Privacy Training	Privacy Training pursuant to RFO 52.224-3	Required prior to beginning performance; annually thereafter
Sexual Assault & Sexual Harassment Prevention and Response Training	In accordance with NAM 1330-52.222-70; each employee shall complete	Required prior to beginning performance; annually thereafter
Monthly Status Report (MSR)	High-level picture of overall system status, Sprint Reviews, Release Notes, Service Level metrics, and a Risk/Issue log.	Monthly, by the 5th business day of the following month.

Documentation Updates	Maintain and update the document library (process, procedures, system diagrams, training, code) to reflect changes to the PIMS systems.	Monthly, by the 5th business day of the following month.
Staffing Plan	Resource mix, contact information, and any proposed changes to key/support staffing.	Monthly, by the 5th business day of the following month.
Quarterly Program Review	Strategic meeting with Government leadership to review SLA performance, burn-rates, and future enhancement roadmaps.	Quarterly, as scheduled by the COR.
Meeting Attendance	Coordinate and provide SME consultation in support meetings requested by the Gov Product Owner.	As requested during standard business hours.

9. Contract Administration Data

The following Government personnel will be responsible for the administration and technical oversight of this requirement:

Task Manager (TM): [TBD at the time of award]

Responsibilities: Monitors technical aspects, performs inspections, and issues written interpretations of technical requirements.

Contracting Officer Representative (COR): [TBD at the time of award]

Responsibilities: Performs surveillance and acts as the primary liaison between the Government and the Contractor.

10. Contractor Response Requirements

Because this requirement is being issued as a Statement of Objectives (SOO), the Contractor shall propose their own innovative technical approach to achieving the Government's objectives.

In response to this SOO, the Contractor shall develop and submit the following as part of their proposal:

- Performance Work Statement (PWS): A detailed PWS that outlines the specific tasks, methodologies (e.g., Agile/Scrum), and labor mix the Contractor will use to achieve the Performance Objectives outlined in Section 5. Once evaluated and approved, this PWS will be incorporated into the final contract.
- Performance Metrics: The PWS shall include a Performance Requirements Summary (PRS). This must define the specific metrics, acceptable quality levels, and financial/administrative disincentives for failing to meet the Service Level Expectations outlined in Section 7.
- Quality Control Plan (QCP): A high-level plan detailing how the Contractor will internally monitor their own performance, manage risks, and ensure the highest quality of code delivery and customer support.
- Transition-In Plan: A brief strategy detailing how the Contractor will achieve the seamless knowledge transfer objective (Section 5.3) upon contract award without disrupting ongoing SERO operations.